

# Making the Forecast Smarter — Walkthrough Script

Credit-Tier Forecast + Forecast-vs-Actual Monitoring

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## Plain-English Summary

We already had a forecast that predicts call volume by day of week and time of year, but it treated every customer the same. We wanted to make it smarter by factoring in customer type too, since we'd already found that customers with lower credit scores call in more often. We also wanted to build a way to check, going forward, whether the forecast is actually accurate.

Along the way, we caught two real data problems — one where customers who'd since canceled service were being silently dropped from the count, and another where a group of customers with a blank (not zero, but truly missing) credit score was being missed. Both were found and fixed before we trusted any of the numbers.

The final result: a forecast broken out by customer credit type, available both as a monthly summary and drillable down to any single day. We also built and tested a way to compare the forecast against real results — and the very first test already flagged something worth watching: real calls came in higher than predicted on both days we checked so far.

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## How to Walk Through It, Slide by Slide

Assume no prior background — explain everything as if for the first time.

### Slide 1 — Title

Introduce the topic in one sentence — making the existing forecast smarter about customer type, and checking it against reality.

*Say something like:*

*“This covers how we made the call forecast smarter by factoring in customer type, and how we’re now checking it against real results.”*

### Slide 2 — Why We're Doing This

Remind them the forecast already existed — this is an upgrade, not a new project from scratch.

Connect to the earlier credit-quality finding directly, since that's what motivated this.

*Say something like:*

*“We already had a forecast for how many calls to expect — we wanted to make it smarter by using what we already learned about customer credit quality.”*

### Slide 3 — How We Did This

Walk the four steps plainly — sort customers, measure real rates, combine with existing forecast, build a checking system.

Mention the tool (SQL) explicitly, and that it's all built from real, existing company data.

*Say something like:*

*"We sorted customers into credit groups, measured how often each group really calls, combined that with our existing day-of-week forecast, and built a way to check our own work going forward."*

#### **Slide 4 — What We Caught Along the Way**

This slide shows real rigor — take your time here, it's worth it.

First issue: explain simply that the first version only counted people still customers today, which quietly dropped anyone who'd since left — cutting the numbers roughly in half.

Second issue: explain that some customers have a credit score marked as exactly zero (a known placeholder) versus truly blank/missing — two different things in the system that both needed the same treatment, and only one was caught at first.

Land the point: both were found and fixed BEFORE any number was trusted, not after presenting something wrong.

*Say something like:*

*"Before trusting any of this, we found two real problems. First, our early version only counted customers still with us today, which accidentally dropped anyone who'd since canceled — cutting our numbers roughly in half. Second, a whole group with a blank (not zero) credit score was being missed the same way. Both are now fixed."*

#### **Slide 5 — The Finding**

Point at the chart and read the three numbers directly — Low, Medium, High.

Land the comparison plainly: roughly double, low vs. high.

*Say something like:*

*"A Low-credit customer calls us about twice as often as a High-credit customer, every single day on average — this confirms what we found before, now with fully corrected numbers."*

#### **Slide 6 — The Combined Forecast by Month**

Explain how to read a stacked bar chart if needed: each full bar is the month's total, and the colors show how much of that total comes from each customer type.

Point out that High-credit customers make up the largest share of the bar every month, since they're the biggest group overall — even though they call less often per person.

*Say something like:*

*"Each bar is a month's total calls, split into the four customer types. High-credit customers still make up the biggest piece, simply because there are so many more of them — even though each one calls less often."*

#### **Slide 7 — We Can Now Drill Into Any Single Day**

Point at the table and note the Sunday row specifically — zero across the board, which is the expected, correct pattern since the call center is closed.

Mention this exists for all 184 days in the forecast, this is just a sample.

*Say something like:*

*"This is new — we can now look at any single day, not just the monthly total, broken into the same four customer groups. Sundays correctly show zero every time, which tells us the math is working right."*

## Slide 8 — Forecast vs. What Actually Happened

Explain what this slide is: the very first real test of the forecast against real results, now that some August days have actually happened.

Point at both bars: actual came in higher than forecasted both times.

Offer the possible explanation honestly, without overstating it: this may connect to the high bills mentioned in this month's other discussions, but it's still early — only two days so far, so this isn't a confirmed pattern yet.

*Say something like:*

*"This is the first real test, comparing what we predicted against what actually happened. Both days came in higher than expected — worth watching, and it may connect to this month's high bills, but it's early, so we're not calling it a pattern yet."*

## Slide 9 — Key Findings

Read the four rows as the full wrap-up.

*Say something like:*

*"So to summarize — the forecast now understands customer type, we caught and fixed two real data issues along the way, the credit-quality pattern held up, and we've built a working way to catch drift going forward."*

## Slide 10 — Next Steps

Frame as practical follow-ons, not open questions.

*Say something like:*

*"Here's where this goes next."*

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## Key Numbers

| Customer Group            | Calls per 1,000 Customers per Day |
|---------------------------|-----------------------------------|
| High Credit (700+)        | 1.914                             |
| Medium Credit (501-700)   | 2.748                             |
| Low Credit (500 or below) | 4.075                             |

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## Next Steps

- **Keep checking forecast vs. reality** — two days isn't enough to know if this is a real pattern or normal noise.
  - **Resolve the system permissions issue** — so the checking process can run automatically instead of by hand.
  - **Watch for a connection to this month's high bills** — may explain why actual calls are running above forecast.
  - **Bring this into staffing conversations** — now that the forecast understands customer type, it can support more precise planning.
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## Questions to Ask

1.

Now that the forecast understands customer type, is this something you'd want factored into staffing decisions directly?

2.

Should we keep tracking the forecast-vs-actual comparison daily, or would weekly be enough once there's more history?

3.

Is the high-bills connection worth digging into further, or should we wait and see if the pattern continues first?

4.

Do you want the same credit-tier breakdown applied to any other forecasting work going forward?

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## If They Ask... (Quick Answers)

**Q: How confident are you in these numbers, given the two problems you found?**

A: Very confident now — we specifically traced both issues back to their exact cause and confirmed the fix worked by checking the total call count matched what we expected, not just accepting a plausible-looking number.

**Q: Why did the forecast only get checked against 2 days so far?**

A: Because that's all the real data that exists right now — today is only August 4th. We'll keep adding more days as they happen.

**Q: Is the forecast wrong, since actual came in higher both times?**

A: Too early to say. Two days isn't enough to know if this is a real shift or normal variation — that's exactly why we built this checking process, so we can tell the difference over time instead of guessing.

**Q: What happens to the 'Unknown Credit Score' group long term?**

A: That group exists because some customer records are missing a usable credit score. It's tracked separately and honestly, rather than guessing which tier those customers belong to.